

Intel Discrete Graphics Core 2 Duo Boards						
Brand	ASUS	ASUS	ASUS	Asus	Biostar	Gigabyte
Model No.	Maximus II Gene	P5Q Premium	P5Q3 Deluxe WiFi @n	Striker II NSE	TPOWER I45	EP43T-UD3L
Price (Rupees)	Rs. 17,850	Rs. 18,250	Rs. 17,900	Rs. 19,750	Rs. 7,950	Rs. 6,700
Overall (Out of 100)	70.92	76.57	79.27	68.73	70.33	62.10
Features (Out of 70)	44.33	50.25	53.05	43.48	44.04	36.14
Performance (Out of 30)	26.59	26.32	26.22	25.25	26.29	25.96
Features						
Chipset	Intel P45	Intel P45	Intel P45	AMD 790i SLI	Intel P45	Intel P43
Socket	LGA775	LGA775	LGA775	LGA775	LGA775	LGA775
Northbridge / Southbridge	Intel P45 / ICH 10R	P45 / ICH10R	P45 / ICH10R	790i SLI	P45 / ICH 10R	Intel P45 / ICH 10
Front Side Bus Speed (MHz)	1600	1600	1600	1600	1600	1600
Memory Type	DDR2	DDR2	DDR3	DDR3	DDR2	DDR3
Max Memory Supported (GB) / No of DIMMs	16 GB / 4	16 GB / 4	16 GB / 4	8 GB / 4	8 GB / 4	8 GB / 4
No. of SATA / IDE Ports	7 / 1	10 / 1	8 / 1	6 / 1	6 / 1	6 / 0
E-SATA Support / No of E-SATA Ports	Y / 1	Y / 1	Y / 1	Y / 2	Y / 2	N
No of PCI Express x16 graphics slots	2	4	3	3	2	1
No. of PCI / PCI x1 / PCI x4 Slots	1 / 1 / 0	2 / 1 / 0	2 / 2 / 0	2 / 1 / 0	2 / 2 / 0	2 / 4 / 0
Multi GPU Support (SLI/CrossFire/N) / No of PCIe Lanes	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	N
Integrated Audio Controller	SupremeFX X-Fi	ADI AD2000B	ADI AD2000B	SupremeFX II	Y	Y
Number of Sound channels	8	8	8	8	8	8
SPDIF / Optical Port	N / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y
No of LAN Ports / 10/100 / Gigabit	1 / Gigabit	4 / Gigabit	2 / Gigabit	2 / Gigabit	1 / Gigabit	1 / Gigabit
Integrated Wi-Fi (Y/N)	N	N	Y	N	N	N
No. of rear USB / FireWire Ports	6 / 1	10 / 1	6 / 1	6 / 1	6 / 0	8 / 0
All Solid State Caps (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	N	Y	Y
BIOS options						
CPU voltage range (volts)	0.85 ~ 2.4	0.85 ~ 2.10	0.85 ~ 2.10	1.1 ~ 2.4	1 ~ 2.5	0.5 ~ 2.0
CPU Voltage increments	0.00625	0.00625	0.00625	0.025	0.05	0.00525
Memory voltage range (volts)	1.8 ~ 3.4	1.8 ~ 3.08	1.5 ~ 2.78	1.5 ~ 3.1	1.888 ~ 3.7	1.1 ~ 2.76
Memory Voltage increments	0.01325	0.02	0.02	0.02	0.05	0.02
Board Layout (So 10)						
Region around the CPU	8	7.5	7.5	8	8	9
Location of SATA ports	9	8	8	7	9	8
Placement of Memory modules	9	7.5	7.5	7	8	7
Graphics card slot and PCI slots	8	7	7	7	7	7
Package Bundle						
No of SATA / PATA Cables Provided	4 / 1	8 / 2	8 / 2	6 / 2	6 / 1	1 / 1
Accessories	LED poster	Cooling fan	Wi-Fi antenna, cooling fan	LED poster, cooling fan, SupremeFX II Audio card	Cooling fan	-
Performance						
PC Mark 05						
CPU	9658	9671	9658	9624	9662	9641
Memory	6641	6646	6630	6534	6580	6523
Graphics	15370	15381	15567	20103	15373	15062
HDD	8850	8820	8851	8292	8778	8859
Overall	9501	9413	9484	8995	9407	9349
ScienceMark (Memory Bandwidth)	6746	6897	6688	6623	6679	6524
3D Mark Vantage						
CPU	38132	38918	38582	36857	37157	37112
GPU	6976	7078	7001	6984	6967	6978
Overall	8766	8898	8802	8759	8743	8755
Cinebench R10	11711	11502	11847	11701	11828	11721
WinRAR 3.8	2570	2557	2530	2121	2518	2334
DivX Video Encoding (100 MB VOB) (sec)	29	32.2	33.1	32	30	30
Sequential File Transfer Test (8 GB File) (sec)	172	171	162.8	174	175	179
Random File Transfer Test (8 GB File) (sec)	192	189.1	193.3	202	196	198
STALKER Clear Sky (1280 x 1024, low)	80.7	81.1	81.2	78	78.8	78.7
Crysis (CPU - 1024 x 768, low)	69	85	84	72	73	72
Crysis (Graphics - 1280 x 1024, high)	45	45	42	45	45	45

category — it's for you to decide the budget you have and what you need from your system. For the Core i7 processors, we strongly believe that the ASUS Rampage II Extreme is the

board to go for if price isn't an issue. At Rs. 28,500, it's a lot to pay for a board and it takes the budget of an Intel Core i7 system very high. The Biostar TPower X58 shockingly is the

next in the line. It might not come with too many fancy audio card modules but is a really solid board for its price. This board just like any other enthusiast board has features

not just on the board but also in the BIOS and in the way the board is laid out. It matches the smaller version of the Rampage II Extreme — the Rampage II Gene. Going away from the